Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Sunday, 18 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Overcast	Partly cloudy	Mostly clear
14° 8°	12° 6°	13° 5°	11° 3°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **A former national security adviser has warned the UK must do more to protect itself from Russian 'hybrid attacks'.**
Lord Ricketts says more money should be spent on improving the resilience of crucial sites like energy, transport, and air traffic control. This comes amid ongoing concerns about potential cyber and other non-military threats.
GEOPOLITICS · UK

2 **Tragic news from Scotland, where a 16-year-old boy and an 80-year-old man have died in a light aircraft crash near Loch Lomond.**
Emergency services were called on Friday afternoon after the incident. Both individuals were sadly pronounced dead at the scene. Investigations are now underway to determine the cause.
ACCIDENT · UK

3 **More NHS staff have been sacked after illegally accessing the medical records of attack victims.**
Nottingham University Hospitals NHS Trust is bringing in a new system to protect patient records. This follows a concerning trend of staff misusing their access to sensitive information.
NHS · UK

4 **The husband of a British woman detained in Egypt for two months is calling on the Prime Minister to intervene.**
Eman el-Shazly has allegedly been held by Egyptian authorities due to her sister's activism. Her husband is desperate for the UK government to help secure her release.
INTERNATIONAL · UK

5 **A Norwegian teenager has been jailed over a murder plot in the UK.**
Johannes Natland, 19, travelled to West Yorkshire last March to carry out a 'hit'. The details of the plot and those involved are still emerging.
CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Marvel fans, get ready to meet a new Welsh superhero, complete with a Cardiff accent!**

Lauren Morais is set to play the villain Lisa Molinari in the upcoming Disney+ superhero series, VisionQuest. It's fantastic to see more regional accents making it into the Marvel universe.

ON AIR — What other UK accents would you love to hear from a superhero or villain?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Harry Styles has debuted a new track in memory of his former One Direction bandmate, Liam Payne.**

The pop star performed the emotional song on the second anniversary of Liam Payne's death. It's a poignant tribute from one friend to another.

ON AIR — What's your favourite One Direction song, and do you think this new track will honour Liam's memory?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

3 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie promises to be 'made by fans for fans' – but can it win over the critics?**

Cast members Noah Centineo, Andrew Koji, and Callina Liang have been discussing the latest video game adaptation. Film adaptations of games can be hit or miss, so hopes are high for this one.

ON AIR — Are you excited for a new 'Street Fighter' film, and which video game movie do you think got it right?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Welsh singer Jamie Miller says a collaboration with an 'Off Campus' star 'gave me chills'.**

His viral hit, 'Babydoll', narrowly missed out on the UK number one spot. Jamie hopes he's 'doing Wales proud' with his growing success and exciting new projects.

ON AIR — Who is your favourite rising star in music right now, and what collaboration would you love to see?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

5 **Dame Judi Dench has joined the campaign to keep 'The Archers' in Birmingham.**

Cast members have compared plans to move the much-loved radio drama from Birmingham to 'Corrie leaving the north-west'. It seems there's strong feeling about keeping the show in its spiritual home.

ON AIR — Do you think it's important for long-running shows like 'The Archers' to stay in their original locations?

TV · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Chelsea goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez was taken to hospital for 'precautionary tests' after their 2-0 win over Everton.**

The win saw Chelsea secure their first clean sheet in nine months. It's a relief to hear the tests were precautionary, and we wish him a speedy recovery.

ON AIR — After such a long wait for a clean sheet, how crucial is this result for Chelsea's confidence moving forward?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England's Red Roses have had their incredible 41-match unbeaten streak ended by Canada in a thrilling WXV Global Series match.**

Shoshanah Seumanutafa's try in the 77th minute sealed a dramatic 24-21 victory for Canada in Toronto. It was a fantastic run, but all good things must come to an end!

ON AIR — Despite the loss, what does this unbeaten run tell us about the strength of women's rugby in England?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Anna Morris has secured a golden hat-trick at the Track Cycling World Championships, winning the women's madison for Great Britain.**

She teamed up with Erin Boothman for the victory in Shanghai. It's been an incredible performance from Morris, showcasing Britain's strength in track cycling.

ON AIR — What an achievement! Does this make you more excited for the next Olympic Games, and which cycling event is your favourite to watch?

CYCLING · UK

4 **Boxing figures are giving their predictions for Saturday's heavyweight world title rematch between Fabio Wardley and Daniel Dubois.**

It's set to be a huge fight, with both boxers eager to claim the heavyweight title. The anticipation is building for what promises to be an explosive encounter.

ON AIR — Who are you backing in this heavyweight rematch, and what makes a great boxing rivalry for you?

BOXING · UK

5 **Britain's Sonay Kartal has reached the Wuhan Open final, continuing a dream week after a six-month injury lay-off.**

She beat former French Open winner Jelena Ostapenko in only her third event back. It's an incredible comeback story and a testament to her determination.

ON AIR — What a fantastic return to form! What's the most impressive sporting comeback you've ever witnessed?

TENNIS · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The surprising joy of 'competitive gardening' is blooming across the nation.**
Green-fingered enthusiasts are finding a new thrill in friendly contests, from the biggest pumpkin to the prettiest petunias, fostering community spirit and a bit of healthy rivalry.

2 **A recent study highlights the calming effect of 'watching a kettle boil'.**
It seems the simple, rhythmic sound and gentle steam offer a moment of unexpected tranquility in our busy day, perfect for a mindful pause before that cup of tea.

3 **The delightful trend of 'decorating your garden shed' is growing.**
No longer just for tools, sheds are being transformed into whimsical retreats, miniature pubs, or even cosy reading nooks, adding a splash of personality to back gardens.

4 **More people are embracing the 'art of perfectly folding laundry'.**
Far from a chore, arranging clothes into neat, uniform piles is being seen as a satisfying skill, bringing a sense of order and calm to the household routine.

5 **The simple pleasure of 'finding a perfectly smooth pebble on the beach' is being celebrated.**
It's a small, tangible reminder of nature's beauty and a free souvenir that often sparks a happy memory of a seaside stroll.

6 **A new appreciation for 'vintage board games' is sweeping through homes.**
Families are rediscovering classic favourites, enjoying screen-free quality time and a healthy dose of retro fun, proving some entertainment never goes out of style.

7 **The comforting ritual of 'listening to the radio whilst doing household chores' is making a comeback.**
It seems a familiar voice and some good tunes can transform mundane tasks into more enjoyable moments, making the time fly by.

Prepflow

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A QUICK, DECISIVE SQUEEZE!

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE AROMA BEFORE THE FIRST SIP.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'comfort sounds' that just make life better, don't we?**
  Whether it's the gentle pitter-patter of rain, the distant whistle of a train, or the purr of a cat, what's a sound that brings you instant calm or happiness?

- **There's something wonderfully satisfying about 'getting to the bottom of a container' of something you love, isn't there?**
  That last scoop of ice cream, the final biscuit from the tin, or the very last drop of your favourite cordial – what's the item you love finishing most?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's true that butterflies taste with their antennae, allowing them to sense nectar from a distance.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896; Zanzibar surrendered after 38 minutes.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one-hundredth of a second.
- Mount Everest grows by about 4 millimetres every year.
- The plastic tips on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The dot over the letters 'i' and 'j' is called a tittle.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SUN 18 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 291 of the year, 74 days left in 2026. Today Alaska Day (Alaska, United States); Christian feast day: Asclepiades of Antioch; Christian feast day: Isaac Jogues; Christian feast day: Luke the Evangelist. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Rhod Gilbert, Welsh comedian
- 1992 — Barry Keoghan, Irish actor
- 1982 — Mark Sampson, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1940 — Cynthia Weil, American songwriter (died 2023)
- 1979 — Ne-Yo, American singer, songwriter, record producer, dancer, and actor
- 1991 — Tyler Posey, American actor and musician
- 1987 — Zac Efron, American actor and singer
- 1951 — Pam Dawber, American actress and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2019 — Riots in Chile's capital Santiago escalate into open battles, with attacks reported at nearly all of the city's 164 Metro stations. President Sebastián Piñera later announces a 15-day state of emergency in the capital.
- 1929 — The Judicial Committee of the Privy Council overrules the Supreme Court of Canada in Edwards v. Canada when it declares that women are considered "Persons" under Canadian law.
- 1977 — German Autumn: A set of events revolving around the kidnapping of Hanns Martin Schleyer and the hijacking of a Lufthansa flight by the Red Army Faction (RAF) comes to an end when Schleyer is murdered and various RAF members allegedly commit suicide.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The state funeral of Field Marshal Erwin Rommel takes place in Ulm, Germany.
- 1979 — The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) begins allowing people to have home satellite earth stations without a federal government license.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1887 — Johannes Brahms conducts the premiere of his Double Concerto, composed for violinist Joseph Joachim and cellist Robert Hausmann.

- 1921 — The Crimean Autonomous Soviet Socialist Republic is formed as part of the Russian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic.
- 1989 — The Space Shuttle Atlantis launches on STS-34 to deploy the Jupiter-bound Galileo space probe.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES MON 19 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 292 of the year, 73 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Coptic Orthodox Church of Alexandria); Christian feast day: Blessed Agnes of Jesus; Christian feast day: Aquilinus of Évreux; Christian feast day: Desiderius (Didier) of Auxerre. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Tracy Chevalier, American-English author
- 1941 — Simon Ward, English actor (died 2012)
- 1968 — Rodney Carrington, American comedian, actor, and singer
- 1977 — Jason Reitman, Canadian-American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1945 — Jeannie C. Riley, American singer
- 1957 — Karl Wallinger, Welsh singer-songwriter, keyboard player, and producer (died 2024)
- 1951 — Annie Golden, American actress and singer
- 1945 — Gloria Jones, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1987 — Black Monday: The Dow Jones Industrial Average falls by 22%, 508 points.
- 1950 — China defeats the Tibetan Army at Chambo.
- 2005 — Hurricane Wilma becomes the most intense Atlantic hurricane on record with a minimum pressure of 882 mb.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1955 — The General Assembly of the European Broadcasting Union approves the staging of the first Eurovision Song Contest.
- 2025 — Pieces of the French Crown Jewels are successfully stolen during a heist on the Louvre Museum in Paris..

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

© 2026 The Radio Business